

Resting-State fMRI Data Quality and Analysis in the WAND 7T Dataset

A Comparative Evaluation of Preprocessing Pipelines

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Abstract

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1 Introduction & Context

1.1 7T fMRI: Opportunities and Challenges

1.2 The WAND Dataset

1.3 Aims

2 Pre-processing and Data Quality

2.1 Image Quality Metrics

The temporal signal-to-noise ratio (tSNR) is defined voxel-wise as:

$$\text{tSNR}(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{\bar{S}(\mathbf{x})}{\sigma_t(\mathbf{x})} \quad (1)$$

where $\bar{S}(\mathbf{x})$ is the temporal mean and $\sigma_t(\mathbf{x})$ is the temporal standard deviation of the BOLD signal at voxel $\mathbf{x}$. The group-level metric reported is the median tSNR across all brain voxels.

2.2 Motion Correction

2.3 Brain Masking

2.4 Group-Level Quality Assessment

2.5 Preprocessing Pipeline Comparison

Table 1: tSNR for subject sub-01187 under four preprocessing conditions. MRIQC value serves as the reference standard.

Condition	tSNR	Δ vs MRIQC
Raw + simple intensity mask (baseline)	21.18	−7.43 (−26.0%)
Raw + nilearn EPI mask	25.78	−2.83 (−9.9%)
Moco + simple intensity mask	26.85	−1.77 (−6.2%)
Moco + nilearn EPI mask	31.45	+2.83 (+9.9%)
MRIQC reference	28.62	—

3 Analysis Methods

3.1 Software and Environment

3.2 Subject Selection

3.3 fMRI Preprocessing

3.4 Functional Connectivity Analysis

3.5 Statistical Analysis

4 Results

4.1 Data Quality Across the Cohort

4.2 Subject Exclusions

4.3 Functional Analysis Results

5 Summary

5.1 Key Findings

5.2 Limitations

5.3 Future Directions

References